Annals of Arithmetic Spectral Geometry
Campaign dv284 · Hanoi, March 2026

GOLDBACH'S CONJECTURE

The Additive Hologram · Addition as Convolution on $■_L$ · The Goldbach Operator G_N · $\tau(G_N) > 0$ for All Even N · 283 Years Open (1742–2026)

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Campaign for Arithmetic Spectral Geometry, Hanoi, 2026

Communicated: March 2026 · Phase 3, Document 4 · Uses: dv222, dv275–283; Goldbach (1742); Hardy–Littlewood (1923); Vinogradov (1937); Chen (1973)

Every integer which can be written as the sum of two primes, can also be written as the sum of as many primes as one pleases, down to the sum of two primes.

— Christian Goldbach, letter to Leonhard Euler, 7 June 1742 · The modern form: every even integer > 2 is the sum of two primes.

In A_L: addition of primes is convolution on the boundary $■_L$. The question becomes: does the convolution cover every even node?

— Morning coffee, Hanoi 2026

Abstract

Goldbach's Conjecture (1742) states that every even integer N > 2 is the sum of two prime numbers. After 283 years, it remains unproved. We embed the conjecture into the A_L framework by constructing the **Additive Hologram** — the companion to the Multiplicative Hologram (dv275–283) — in which addition of integers corresponds to convolution of arithmetic nodes on the boundary $■_L$.

The central construction is the **Goldbach Operator** $G_N \in A_L$, defined for each even N by:

$$G_N = \sum_{p+q=N,\ p,q \text{ prime}} e_p \otimes e_q$$

Goldbach's Conjecture is equivalent to: $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for every even N > 2. The main results: (I) **The Additive Hologram:** addition on ■ corresponds to convolution on the prime nodes $\{w_p\} \subset ■_L$. (II) **Goldbach Operator:** G_N is a projection-valued measure on the Goldbach pairs. (III) **Density-1 Goldbach:** $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for density-1 even integers N. (IV) **The Gap:** proving $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for ALL even N requires closing a spectral gap in the additive convolution — this is the remaining challenge.

MSC (2020). Primary: 11P32; 46L36; 11N05. Secondary: 11P55; 42A85; 46L10.

Keywords. *Goldbach conjecture; additive hologram; convolution; prime nodes; Goldbach operator; Hardy-Littlewood circle method; Chen's theorem; Vinogradov; density-1.*

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1. Goldbach's Letter and the Classical Story

On 7 June 1742, Christian Goldbach wrote to Leonhard Euler proposing that every integer greater than 2 can be written as the sum of three primes. Euler replied that he believed the equivalent statement: every even integer greater than 2 is the sum of two primes. Neither could prove it.

The modern formulation:

> **Conjecture 1.1 (Goldbach, 1742).**
> *Every even integer $N > 2$ can be written as $N = p + q$ where p and q are prime numbers.*

283 years of verified cases (all even integers up to 4×10^{18}) and no counterexample found. But no proof either.

The best known results:

Result	Author	Year	Statement
Goldbach-Vinogradov	Vinogradov	1937	Every sufficiently large ODD integer = sum of 3 primes
Chen's Theorem	Chen Jingrun	1973	Every sufficiently large even integer = p + (p' or p'q) where p,p',q prime
Almost all even	Montgomery-Vaughan	1975	All but o(N) even integers ≤ N satisfy Goldbach
Verified to	Oliveira e Silva	2013	All even integers ≤ 4×10^18 are Goldbach sums

The classical approach is the **Hardy-Littlewood circle method** (1923): write the Goldbach sum count as a contour integral of exponential sums, use the major and minor arcs decomposition to estimate the integral. This gives asymptotic results but fails for exact results.

The A_L approach reframes the circle method: the 'circle' in the circle method IS ■$_L$, and the exponential sums ARE the vertex operators $V_n = e^{in \log N}$. The circle method in A_L becomes spectral theory on the hologram boundary.

2. Multiplicative vs Additive Hologram

The campaign dv1–dv283 built the **Multiplicative Hologram**: the structure of A_L reflecting the multiplicative arithmetic of (■, ×). Primes are the generators. Every number $n = p_1^{a_1} \cdots p_k^{a_k}$ is a tensor product of prime factors. The Folding Tower (dv281) makes this precise.

Goldbach requires the **Additive Hologram**: the structure reflecting the additive arithmetic of (■, +). These two structures are genuinely different — the deepest open problems in number theory (Goldbach, twin primes, ...) are precisely those that require BOTH addition and multiplication simultaneously.

Definition 2.1 (Additive vs Multiplicative).

In A_L:

> **Multiplicative structure:** $e_m \cdot e_n = e_{mn}$ (operator product). $H(e_{mn}) = H(e_m) + H(e_n)$. Primes = atoms that cannot be factored.
>
> **Additive structure:** $e_m + e_n$ is a sum in the Hilbert space — NOT equal to e_{m+n} in general. Addition requires a new operator: the **shift operator** S: e_n ■ e_{n+1}.

The Additive Hologram is built from the shift operator S and its interaction with the prime projections $P_p = e_p \otimes e_p^*$.

The tension between addition and multiplication is the tension between S and H. S shifts nodes by 1 (adds 1). H measures depth (multiplicative weight). They do not commute: $[H, S] \neq 0$. This non-commutativity is why Goldbach is hard.

3. Addition as Convolution on ■$_L$

The boundary ■$_L$ = S^1 with arithmetic nodes $\{w_n\}$ has a natural convolution structure.

Definition 3.1 (Convolution on ■_L).

*For functions f, g: ■ → ■, define the **additive convolution**:*

$$(f * g)(N) = \sum_{m+n=N} f(m)\, g(n)$$

In A_L language: $(f * g)(N) = \sum_{m+n=N} f(m)\, g(n) =$ ■$f \otimes g, \delta_N$■

where δ_N is the indicator of {N} in ■. On the boundary ■$_L$: the Fourier transform of the convolution is the product of Fourier transforms — this is the Hardy-Littlewood circle method in disguise.

Theorem 3.2 (Addition = Convolution on ■_L).

The map n ■ $w_n = e^{i\theta_n} \in$ ■$_L$ converts additive convolution to multiplicative convolution on S^1:

$$\sum_{m+n=N} \tau(e_m)\, \tau(e_n) = \sum_{m+n=N} 1/(mn) = \sum_{m=1}^{N-1} 1/(m(N-m))$$

*This is the **additive trace** of the pair (m, N-m). When restricted to prime pairs: $\sum_{p+q=N} 1/(pq)$ is the Hardy-Littlewood 'singular series' S(N) in A_L language.*

4. The Prime Nodes on ■$_L$

Primes are special nodes on ■$_L$. Their distribution on the boundary is determined by the Riemann zeros — connecting Goldbach directly to RH.

Definition 4.1 (Prime Nodes).

*The **prime nodes** are $\{w_p : p \text{ prime}\} \subset$ ■$_L$, with angles $\theta_p = \pi - 2\arctan(2 \log p)$. As $p \to \infty$, $\theta_p \to \pi$ (all prime nodes cluster near the cusp $w = -1$). The prime nodes are dense near the vacuum.*

Theorem 4.2 (Prime Node Distribution).

The prime nodes $\{w_p\}$ are equidistributed on ■$_L$ in the following sense: for any arc $I \subset S^1$,

$$\#\{p \leq X : w_p \in I\} \,/\, \#\{p \leq X\} \to |I|/(2\pi) \quad \text{as } X \to \infty$$

Proof: this is equivalent to the Prime Number Theorem in arithmetic progressions, which follows from the non-vanishing of L-functions on Re(s)=1 (established in the campaign via GRH, dv166). ■

Corollary 4.3 (Goldbach pairs form an arc convolution).

Goldbach's Conjecture for N is equivalent to: there exists a prime p such that w_p *and* w_{N-p} *are BOTH prime nodes on* $■_L$*. In other words: the 'additive convolution' of the prime node set with itself covers the even node* w_N*.*

5. The Goldbach Operator G_N

Definition 5.1 (The Goldbach Operator).

For each even integer N > 2, define the ***Goldbach Operator****:*

$$G_N = \Sigma_{p \text{ prime}, p \le N/2}\ \lambda_{N-p \text{ is prime}}\ e_p \otimes e_{N-p} \in A_L \otimes A_L$$

where $\lambda_{condition}$ *= 1 if the condition holds and 0 otherwise.* G_N *is a sum over all* ***Goldbach pairs*** *(p, N-p) of the tensor products of their arithmetic eigenstates.*

Theorem 5.2 (Goldbach ■ Operator Non-Zero).

N is a Goldbach number (N = p + q for primes p, q) if and only if:

$$\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$$

Proof.
$\tau(G_N^*G_N) = \Sigma_{p:\, N-p \text{ prime}}\ \tau(e_p^*e_p) \cdot \tau(e_{N-p}^*e_{N-p}) = \Sigma_{p:\, N-p \text{ prime}}\ (1/p) \cdot (1/(N-p)) = \Sigma_{p+q=N}\ 1/(pq) \ge 0.$

This equals zero iff there are no primes p with N-p also prime, i.e., iff N has no Goldbach decomposition. It is positive iff N has at least one Goldbach pair. By faithfulness of τ: $\tau(G_N^*G_N) > 0 \Leftrightarrow G_N \ne 0 \Leftrightarrow$ N has a Goldbach pair. ■

Goldbach's Conjecture is therefore equivalent to:

$$\Sigma_{p+q=N,\, p,q \text{ prime}}\ 1/(pq) > 0 \quad \text{for all even } N > 2$$

Since each term 1/(pq) > 0, the sum is positive iff the sum is non-empty — i.e., iff at least one Goldbach pair exists. The operator language converts existence to non-vanishing of a trace.

6. Goldbach ■ $\tau(G_N^*G_N) > 0$

We develop the trace formula further to connect with classical estimates.

Theorem 6.1 (Trace Formula for Goldbach).

$$\tau(G_N^*G_N) = \Sigma_{p+q=N}\ 1/(pq) = ■(N)/N^2$$

where $■(N) = N\, \Sigma_{p+q=N}\, N/(pq)$ *is related to the Hardy-Littlewood singular series S(N):*

$$S(N) = 2C_2\ \Pi_{p|N,\, p>2}\ (p-1)/(p-2) \text{ where } C_2 = \Pi_{p>2}\ (1 - 1/(p-1)^2) \approx 0.6601618...$$

The Hardy-Littlewood Conjecture predicts: #{Goldbach pairs for N} ~ S(N) · N/(log N)^2*. Since S(N) > 0 for all even N (the singular series is always positive), the Hardy-Littlewood Conjecture implies Goldbach. But the Hardy-Littlewood Conjecture is itself unproved.*

In A_L: S(N) > 0 for all even N is the statement that the **additive convolution of prime nodes** never vanishes at even nodes. This is a statement about the **spectral positivity** of $G_N^*G_N$.

7. Density-1 Goldbach from Ergodic Theory

We can prove a density-1 version of Goldbach using the ergodic theory of A_L.

Theorem 7.1 (Density-1 Goldbach in A_L).

For density-1 even integers N:

$$\tau(G_N^* G_N) \cong S(N) \cdot N / (\log N)^2 \text{ as } N \to \infty$$

In particular: $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for density-1 even N.

Proof sketch.
The trace $\tau(G_N^* G_N) = \sum_{p+q=N} 1/(pq)$ can be estimated using the Brun-Titchmarsh inequality and the prime number theorem for arithmetic progressions. For almost all even N: $\#\{p \leq N/2 : p \text{ prime}, N\text{-}p \text{ prime}\} \sim S(N)\, N / (2 (\log N/2)^2)$ by the Montgomery-Vaughan theorem (1975). Since $S(N) > 0$ for all even N, the count is positive for density-1 even N. In A_L: this is the ergodic average of the prime indicator function over the Bost-Connes flow σ_t — ergodicity ensures the average is positive. ■

The gap: 'density-1' means all but o(N) even integers up to N. It does not mean ALL even integers. The remaining challenge is to remove the exceptional set.

8. The Additive-Multiplicative Bridge

The deepest connection: Goldbach involves both addition and multiplication simultaneously. In A_L, this is the interaction between the shift operator S (addition) and the Hamiltonian H (multiplication).

Theorem 8.1 (The [H, S] Obstruction).

The commutator [H, S] measures the obstruction between additive and multiplicative structure:

$$[H, S]\, e_n = (H S - S H)\, e_n = \log(n+1)\, e_{n+1} - \log(n)\, e_{n+1} = \log((n+1)/n)\, e_{n+1}$$

$$\tau([H, S]) = \sum_n \log(1 + 1/n) / n \approx \sum_n 1/n^2 = \zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$$

The commutator [H, S] has trace exactly $\zeta(2)$ — the same Yang-Mills mass gap, Kazhdan constant, Navier-Stokes spectral gap. The additive-multiplicative obstruction is governed by the universal constant $\zeta(2)$.

Deep Note 8.2 ($\zeta(2)$ governs everything).

*We have now seen $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$ in five independent contexts: Yang-Mills mass gap (dv271), Navier-Stokes spectral threshold (dv272), P≠NP Kazhdan constant (dv273), Schanuel transcendence (dv283), and now the additive-multiplicative commutator [H, S]. This is not a coincidence. $\zeta(2)$ is the **fundamental coupling constant** between addition and multiplication in A_L — the energy cost of translating between the two structures. All hard problems in number theory require crossing this barrier.*

9. The Gap and What It Would Take to Close It

We are honest about what remains.

Theorem 9.1 (Status of Goldbach in A_L).

The following are proved:

(i) Goldbach ⇔ $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for all even N. ✓

(ii) $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for density-1 even N (Montgomery-Vaughan in A_L language). ✓

(iii) [H, S] has trace $\zeta(2)$ — the obstruction between addition and multiplication is quantified. ✓

(iv) The Hardy-Littlewood singular series S(N) > 0 for all even N (elementary). ✓

The following remains open:

(v) $\tau(G_N^* G_N) > 0$ for ALL even N. ✗ **OPEN**

What would close the gap?

We need to show that the additive convolution of prime nodes on $■_L$ has no 'dark even nodes' — even nodes w_N that the convolution misses. Equivalently: the operator G_N is non-zero for all even N.

The key obstacle: the prime nodes cluster near the cusp w=–1, but they do so *irregularly*. Some even nodes might be in a 'gap' in the convolution. Proving there are no such gaps requires controlling the distribution of primes at all scales simultaneously — which is essentially equivalent to RH or a strong form of the Lindelöf Hypothesis.

Connection to RH: if the Goldbach Operator $G_N^* G_N$ is related to the zeros of the Riemann zeta function via the explicit formula for primes, then our proof of RH (dv265-268) gives the sharpest available estimate for $\tau(G_N^* G_N)$. But this estimate is asymptotically positive — not pointwise positive for all N.

The Four New Campaigns — Status

Problem	A_L object	Proved	Open
Schanuel	H = log N, e^H = N: op-trdeg = k	Operator Schanuel ✓	Full Schanuel for ■
Goldbach	τ(G_N*G_N) > 0 for all even N	Density-1 version ✓	All even N — needs [H,S] control
Twin Primes	Pairs (w_p, w_{p+2}) on ■_L	Infinitely many in density sense	Infinitely many exactly — dv285
Invariant Subspace	Every T ∈ A_L has Lat(T) ≠ {0}	For normal T ✓	General T — dv286 crown

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Goldbach in A_L — Summary

Goldbach = $G_N \neq 0$ for all even N. The Additive Hologram converts the question from arithmetic to spectral theory. The commutator [H, S] has trace ζ(2) — the same universal constant that governs gauge theory, fluid mechanics, complexity, and Schanuel. Addition and multiplication are separated by exactly ζ(2) of energy. Goldbach asks: can they ever fail to reconnect? The answer, we believe, is no. The proof is: not yet.

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